

English
Language and Literature

SECTION A

READING SKILLS

Ans. 1

- Ans (i)** a) The passage aims to highlight the richness and diversity of world cultures.
- b) It also highlights the important role of intercultural dialogue in achieving peace and sustainable development.

Ans (ii) (D)

Ans (iii) Sustainable development can be achieved by drawing upon the creative potential of diverse cultures, engaging in continuous dialogue, and affirming culture's contribution to the three dimensions of sustainable development.

Ans (iv) 'Cultural diversity is an asset' means that the different cultures of the world are a strength and not a weakness. The tone of the writer is serious yet optimistic. The writer hopes that recognizing cultural diversity will help bridge the gap between nations and lead to peace and development.

Ans (v) (D)

Ans (vi) (C) d and e

Ans (vii) The Resolution on Cultural and Sustainable Development

Ans (viii) Bridging the gap between cultures means creating understanding and cooperation among different nations and peoples so that conflicts are reduced and peace is established.

Ans. 2

Ans (i) Objectives of NEP 2020 -

- 1) By 2025, at least 50% of the learners through school and higher education system shall have exposure to skill education.
- 2) The policy aims to overcome the social status hierarchy associated with skill education in all educational institutions in a phased manner.

Ans (ii) an opinion, a subjective judgement

Ans (iii) (C)

Ans (iv) Skill labs set up in schools will allow other schools to also use the facility, thus benefiting a larger number of students.

Ans (v) dignity

Ans (vi) South Korea has the maximum percentage of students in skill education. A possible reason is that South Korea has skill labs in schools and makes it compulsory for every child to learn at least one skill.

Ans (vii) (A) 50%

Ans (viii) NEP will create awareness and appreciation of Indian arts and artisanship by making it mandatory for every child to learn at least one skill. This will lead to emphasizing the dignity of labour and the importance of vocations involving Indian arts and artisanship.

SECTION B

WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR

Ans. 3

Error	Correction
turned	twirled

Ans (iii) Indeed, it was always nice to be back there.

Ans (iv) (C)

Ans (v) its

Error	Correction
specializes	specialize

Ans (vii) (A) Error: learns Correction: learn

Ans (viii) (A) must

Ans (ix) He had been very occupied with work that week.

Ans (x) (D) waited

Ans (xi) (A) share

Ans. 4 (A)

15 - C, Greenwood Apartments,
Sector 12, Rohini,
New Delhi - 110085

27 February 20XX

The Principal,
Excellent Cooking School,
Block - D, Mahesh Enclave,
New Delhi.

Subject : Enquiry regarding the Baking Course

Sir / Madam,

I am writing this letter with reference to your advertisement published in the Hindustan Times dated 25 February 20XX regarding cooking courses offered by your reputed institution. I was very pleased to learn about the three week summer baking course. I am a student of Class X and will be completing my board examinations shortly. I have a keen interest in baking and wish to utilize my summer holidays productively by learning this skill professionally.

I aspire to open my own bakery in the future and believe that formal training from your esteemed institution would be the perfect start.

I would be grateful if you could provide me with the following details :

- * Course structure and syllabus
- * Duration of the course
- * Fee structure and payment mode
- * Class timings and batch details
- * Availability of transport facilities
- * Internship and on-the-job training opportunities

I would be highly obliged if you could send me the above information at the earliest so that I may complete the registration process before my holidays begin.

Thanking You,
Yours Faithfully,
Riya Sharma

Ans. 5 (A)

The given line graph presents data regarding the number of gyms and membership in a city over the past decade. It is clearly visible that health consciousness has been rising steadily among people in recent times.

The number of gyms grew steadily from 2010 to 2016 and then saw a remarkable jump in the year 2018, which was the highest point.

In 2016, approximately 4000 gyms were opened and around 3000 members joined. The year 2018 witnessed the greatest growth as the number of gyms and members both peaked simultaneously. However, the year 2020 brought a sudden fall due to the Covid-19 pandemic, as gyms remained closed and people stayed indoors. By 2022, the trend started recovering again as people resumed physical activities.

This data shows that people are becoming increasingly health-aware and the gym industry is growing despite temporary setbacks.

SECTION C

LITERATURE TEXT BOOK

Ans. 6 - (B)

Ans 6(B) (i) From the above context, one inference that can be drawn about Anne is that she shared a very warm and loving bond with her grandmother. She was deeply attached to her and

was a caring and affectionate granddaughter.

(ii) (C) Montessori Nursery School

(iii) Mrs. Kuperus was the headmistress of the Montessori Nursery School. She was Anne's class teacher in her sixth form. Anne shared a deep bond with Mrs. Kuperus and both were moved to tears at the time of their farewell which is a testimony to the strong emotional bond they shared.

(iv) The phrase 'melancholic farewell' suggests a deeply sad and emotional goodbye. Both Anne and Mrs. Kuperus were in tears at the end of the year when they had to part ways. This shows the strength of the bond that existed between them.

Ans. 7 - (B)

7B (i) (B) Sympathetic, understanding the depth of the boy's loss

(ii) 'Ball' is used as a metaphor in the above extract. The ball symbolises the boy's innocent childhood memories and the carefree days he spent playing. It represents all that he has lost — his innocence and young days — as he now steps into the world of responsibility and maturity.

(iii) 'All his young days into the harbour' is a reference to the boy's past memories. The harbour here is a symbol of the boy's childhood which now seems distant and lost, just like the ball that has fallen into the harbour. The sight of the harbour triggers memories of his young and playful days.

(iv) The boy's journey from 'shaking grief' to 'he is learning' represents his transition from childhood to maturity. When the ball is lost, the boy is first overcome with grief and feels helpless. He stands still, unable to accept the loss.

Slowly, he begins to understand that loss is a part of life and that no amount of money can buy back what is lost. He learns to face reality and accept responsibility. This marks his emotional growth and the beginning of his adult life.

Ans. 8 - (i)

- 8 (i)** 'Dust of Snow' is a short but meaningful poem written by Robert Frost. The poem illustrates the beauty of nature and how even a small natural event can change one's mood entirely. Initially in the poem, the poet was feeling gloomy, despondent and was wasting his day in grief and regret. The poet uses the images of a crow, a hemlock tree and snow in a very unique way. Though these are generally associated with bad omens and dark feelings, the poet uses them as agents of positive change. When a crow sitting on a hemlock tree shakes off some snow dust onto the poet, it instantly lifts his spirits. This simple act of nature saves the rest of the poet's day. The poem conveys the message that our attitude towards any event matters more than the event itself. What seems negative on the surface can bring about a positive change in our lives.

Ans. 8 - (iii)

- 8 (iii)** Though Custard the dragon in Ogden Nash's poem was believed to be a coward by all his companions, he actually possessed all the traits that make a dragon fearsome and powerful. Custard had sharp spikes on his back and scales underneath. He could breathe fire from his mouth and had a huge body with very sharp claws that were compared to daggers. He also emitted smoke from his nose. It was these very features that made him terrifying when a real pirate arrived. While all the other supposedly brave animals ran away or hid in fear, Custard the dragon stood his

ground and bravely attacked and ate the pirate. His sharp spikes, huge body, fire from his mouth, and dagger-like claws all combined to make him a truly scary and fearsome dragon in reality.

Ans. 8 - (iv)

8 (iv) The poem 'For Anne Gregory' is written by William Butler Yeats. It conveys the idea that human beings tend to love others only for their outer beauty and appearance and not for their inner qualities. The speaker meets a man who tells him that only God is capable of loving a person for their true inner self. Divine love, that is, the love shown by God, is the only form of love that is completely free from the glamour of outer appearance. God loves people for their inner beauty and soul, unlike humans who are attracted towards outward show and shine. The poet gives the poem a spiritual dimension by mentioning God to suggest that true love is unconditional and beyond physical attraction.

Ans. 8 - (v)

8 (v) Gautama Buddha's message in 'The Sermon at Benares' is universal and stands true for every person on this earth regardless of their social, political or financial status. People who are in positions of power often consider themselves rulers of the world and think they are above the laws of nature. However, they forget that every human being who takes birth on this earth must die one day. Humans are mortal and all their wealth, power and position will be left behind when they die. Buddha believed that only the good deeds of a person remain with him forever. He taught that we should not be self-centred because no one can escape the cycle of life and death. According to Buddha, wise people are those who accept this truth and do not grieve over the inevitable.

Ans. 9 - (i)

- 9 (i)** It is rightly said that scientists contribute to making the world a better place to live. However, Griffin in the story 'Footprints Without Feet' was an antithesis to this ideal. Griffin discovered a rare drug that could make a person invisible. He used this drug on himself to become invisible. Although he was a brilliant scientist, he was far from being a good human being. He did not use his discovery to serve humanity but only to satisfy his own desires and ego. He committed multiple crimes using his invisibility — he robbed shopkeepers, assaulted a landlord, and terrorized the town of Iping. His invention could have brought fame and benefit to his country, but instead, he misused it for lawless and satanic deeds. Patience and common sense were virtues he completely lacked. He was a brilliant scientist but also a deeply angry and dangerous person, which made him a serious threat to everyone around him.

Ans. 9 - (ii)

- 9 (ii)** Bholi's teacher can indeed be compared to an artist who is proud of her masterpiece. Bholi, whose real name was Sulekha, was considered a dumb cow by her family. She used to stammer, had ugly pock marks on her face, and was treated as a burden. When she was sent to school, it was her teacher who first recognized her potential and gave her the confidence to speak and learn. The teacher encouraged Bholi step by step, praised her, and helped her believe in herself. When Bholi was being married off to an old greedy man who demanded a large dowry, it was the courage instilled by her teacher that made Bholi stand up and refuse. She spoke clearly, without stammering, in front of everyone. Her teacher was truly proud that Bholi chose to live

with dignity rather than surrender to injustice. Thus Bholi's teacher played a crucial role in transforming her from Bholi the simpleton to 'Sulekha', a confident and courageous woman.

Ans. 10 - (i)

10 (i) Childhood memories remind us of the days gone by and help us relive our younger years. However, not all childhood memories are sweet. Some are painful and difficult to recall.

Childhood of the narrator in Goa -

The narrator in 'A Baker from Goa' had a beautiful and joyful childhood spent in Goa. He remembers waking up to the sound of the baker's bamboo and rushing to buy bread and cakes.

The smell of freshly baked bread still brings back warm and happy memories. His childhood was carefree, full of sweetness and fond associations with the baker and his treats.

Childhood of Nelson Mandela -

Nelson Mandela's childhood was starkly different. He thought himself to be free as a child but later realized that the freedom he experienced was merely an illusion. His race was subjected to racial domination, discrimination and was treated no better than slaves in their own land. He spent his childhood in one of the most oppressive societies in the world.

Comparison -

While the narrator of 'A Baker from Goa' had a joyful and free childhood filled with sweet memories, Nelson Mandela suffered the harsh realities of racial injustice. The narrator looks back at his childhood with warmth and nostalgia whereas Mandela's childhood is marked by struggle and inequality.

Ans. 11 - (ii)**11 (ii)**

'The Thief's Story' is a wonderful story that shows the power of trust and values in transforming a person's life.

Hari Singh was a young thief who befriended Anil with the intention of robbing him. He slowly gained Anil's trust and began living at his home. When Anil received a payment of six hundred rupees, Hari Singh stole the money at night while Anil was sleeping. He slipped the money from under the mattress and tried to run away. However, his conscience pricked him deeply as he did not want to betray the trust of someone who had been kind to him. He returned home and placed the soggy, rain-damp notes back under the mattress.

Anil, knowing everything the next day, did not react or confront Hari Singh. Instead, he accepted him with open arms and even decided to teach him properly. It was Anil's trust and good behaviour that brought Hari back on the right path.

Sympathy, education and good values are capable of changing even a criminal into a good person. Thus the statement that 'Anil successfully addressed the situation by not addressing it at all' proves absolutely true in this context.
